# The Ultimate AI Cheat Sheet

Practical AI for small and medium businesses, in plain English.

SAVE THIS · PART 1 OF 4

## 1 Which tool for which job

**Microsoft 365 Copilot**
Your team lives in Microsoft

**Gemini**
You run on Google

**ChatGPT**
You want one all-rounder

**Claude** OUR PICK
Best writing, analysis and long documents

Start with the one your team already pays for.

## 2 The prompt formula

Role + Task + Context + Format

✗ "Write a follow-up email."

✓ "As our sales manager, write a follow-up to a client gone quiet after a quote. They run a family bakery. Under 120 words, one clear next step."

Paste in an example of good work and it will follow it.

## 3 Hand these to AI first

**Sales**
Proposals, follow-ups, call prep, LinkedIn posts

**Customers**
Reply drafts, FAQs, complaints, review replies

**Operations**
Process guides from a voice note, checklists

**Finance**
Explain the numbers, chase late payers

**Admin**
Meeting notes, actions, agendas, job adverts

## 4 Twelve useful prompt starters

01 You are our [role]. Write [task].
02 Turn these notes into a summary.
03 Rewrite this to be clearer and shorter.
04 Give three options, then pick one.
05 What should I ask before deciding?
06 Find the weak points in this proposal.
07 Put this in a table with [columns].
08 Explain this report to a non-expert.
09 Draft a reply that says no politely.
10 Turn this into a step-by-step checklist.
11 Summarise this thread and list actions.
12 Write three subject lines for this.

## 5 Teach AI your business

- Projects in Claude and ChatGPT
- Gems in Gemini
- Add price list, tone guide, FAQs
- Connect email, calendar, files

## 6 Never paste in

- ✗ Customer personal data
- ✗ Passwords or bank details
- ✗ Anything under NDA
- ✗ Contracts and HR files
- ✗ Unpublished financial results

## 7 Check before it leaves

- ✓ Facts, figures and dates
- ✓ Names and spellings
- ✓ Tone for this customer
- ✓ Anything legal or financial
- ✓ Promises you can't keep

## 8 Habits of good users

- ✓ Give it an example
- ✓ Tell it who will read it
- ✓ Ask it to critique itself
- ✓ Reply to improve, don't restart
- ✓ Save prompts that work

## 9 Start this week

**Pick one weekly job**
Like the Monday report

**Write the prompt**
Role, task, context, format

**Save as a template**
In a shared Project

**Measure time back**
Minutes before and after

## 10 Power moves

**Talk, don't type**
Voice notes into emails and plans

**Show it a picture**
Screenshots, receipts, whiteboards

**Let it interview you**
"Ask me five questions first"

**Ask for a table**
Then turn it into an email or slide

## Key terms

**Prompt**
The instruction you give the AI

**LLM**
The engine behind tools like these

**Hallucination**
A confident answer that is wrong

**Context window**
How much it can read at once

**Connector**
A link to your email, files or apps

**Agent**
AI that does tasks, not just answers

Share with someone who needs this

Comment "AI" for the full guide

AIforCompanies

# Prompts for every part of your business

Copy, paste, fill in the brackets. Works in any AI assistant.



3 More on “Hand these to AI first” from page 1

## Sales

- Follow up on **[quote]**. Keep it brief.
- Turn these call notes into actions.
- Three questions to ask **[company]**.

Attach: the quote or your call notes

## Customer service

- Reply calmly to this complaint.
- Turn these emails into an FAQ.
- Make this reply warmer and clearer.

Attach: the customer’s message

## Operations

- Turn this voice note into a guide.
- Write a checklist for **[task]**.
- Which steps here could we cut?

Attach: a voice note transcript or notes

## Finance

- Explain these numbers simply.
- What changed since last month?
- Chase this late invoice, politely.

Attach: a report or export, never bank logins

## People and HR

- Write a job advert for a **[role]**.
- Five interview questions on **[skill]**.
- Turn our handbook into one page.

Attach: your notes, not personal files

## Marketing

- Ten post ideas for **[audience]**.
- Rewrite this post in our tone.
- Turn this article into five posts.

Attach: a past post you liked

## Before and after

2 The prompt formula

WHAT IT ADDS ✓ Role ✓ Length ✓ Details ✓ Next step

✕ “Write a job advert.”

✓ “Write a job advert for a part-time bookkeeper. Plain English, 150 words. List hours and pay range, and end with how to apply.”

The more it knows, the less you have to fix.

## Five phrases that lift any answer

- “Tell me what you assumed.”
- “Match the tone of this example.”
- “Write it for a busy managing director.”
- “Give me the short version first.”
- “What am I missing?”

## Fix a bad answer

8 Habits of good users

| IF IT IS | REPLY WITH |
|---|---|
| Too long | “Cut this by half. Keep the main point.” |
| Too generic | “Use our details. Here is more context: **[context]**” |
| Wrong tone | “Make it warmer, more formal or more direct.” |
| Wrong facts | “Check each figure against the file I attached.” |
| Off target | “Here is an example of what good looks like.” |

## Prompt library

- **One shared document** — Every prompt that worked
- **Name it by the job** — “Quote follow-up”, “Monday report”
- **Note what to attach** — So anyone can reuse it
- **Review it monthly** — Keep the ones people use

## Chain prompts for bigger jobs

10 Power moves

**Research** — “What do we know?” → **Outline** — “Suggest a structure” → **Draft** — “Write section one” → **Critique** — “What is weak here?” → **Finish** — “Fix it, then tighten”

One job per message, in the same chat. Each step builds on the last.

# Set AI up for your business

Do this once. Every answer after it gets better.



5 More on “Teach AI your business” from page 1

## Your company brief

| | |
|---|---|
| Who we are | Family bakery, 3 shops, 40 staff |
| What we sell | Bread, cakes, wholesale to cafés |
| Our customers | Local families and independent cafés |
| How we sound | Warm, plain English, never pushy |
| Never say | “Artisanal”, “family-run since forever” |
| Set answers | Delivery times, allergens, returns |

Write it once. Paste it into every Project or Gem.

## Set up a Project or Gem

**Create one per job**
Claude and ChatGPT: Projects. Gemini: Gems

**Add your instructions**
Your brief, plus how this job is done

**Upload reference files**
The six shown below

**Start related chats there**
Every chat starts with your brief and files

## Good files to upload

- **Price list** — So quotes are right
- **Tone guide** — Emails you liked
- **FAQs** — Your best answers
- **Best past work** — Proposals that won
- **Product sheets** — Specs and features
- **Process notes** — How jobs get done

## Instructions that work

**For writing**

“Write in our tone. Short sentences. UK English. End with one clear next step.”

**For numbers**

“Show your working. Flag anything unusual. Never guess a missing figure.”

**For customer replies**

“Be warm and brief. Use our standard answers. Escalate refunds to a person.”

## Use a business account for work

1 Which tool

**Microsoft 365 Copilot** ✓
Prompts and responses not used to train the models

**Gemini in Google Workspace** ✓
Your content not used to train Gemini

**ChatGPT Business and Enterprise** ✓
Business data not used for training by default

**Claude for Work** ✓
Inputs and outputs not used for training by default

From each vendor’s own policy pages, October 2026. Free and personal plans differ: check the settings. Not legal advice.

## Connect your tools safely

Key terms

- ✓ **Start with one connector:** add more as you trust it
- ✓ **Share folders, not your whole drive**
- ✓ **Use read-only access first:** where it is offered
- ✓ **Check what each connector can see**
- ✓ **Switch off what you don’t use**
- ✓ **Review access every quarter**

## Roll it out to your team

**Pick a champion** → One person who enjoys it

**Share the brief** → Same facts for everyone

**Share the prompts** → Your library from page 2

**Swap wins weekly** → Ten minutes in a team meeting

Start with the people who repeat the same task most.

# Use AI safely, and prove it works

Check the output, protect your data, measure the time it gives back.

PART 4 OF 4

## Spot a wrong answer

7 Check before it leaves

**Very confident, no source**
Ask: “Where does this come from?”

**Figures that don’t add up**
Recheck totals yourself

**Names or dates you never gave it**
It may have invented them

**Quotes you can’t find**
Never publish an unchecked quote

**Long but vague**
Ask for specifics, or a shorter answer

## What AI is still weak at

- ✕ **Very recent events:** unless it searches the web
- ✕ **Exact maths on big data sets:** use a spreadsheet
- ✕ **Legal or tax certainty:** ask a professional
- ✕ **Anything it cannot see:** attach the file
- ✕ **Your unwritten know-how:** write it in your brief
- ✕ **Knowing when it is wrong:** a person checks

## A six-rule AI policy

6 Never paste in

| | |
|---|---|
| **Accounts** | Use business accounts for work, never personal ones |
| **Data** | No customer, staff or confidential data unless approved |
| **Checking** | A person reviews everything before it goes out |
| **Honesty** | Tell clients if they ask whether AI helped |
| **Reporting** | Flag anything that looks wrong or unsafe |
| **Ownership** | One person owns the tools, settings and access |

Check your privacy notice covers AI tools. A starting point, not legal advice.

## Track the time it saves

| JOB | BEFORE | WITH AI |
|---|---|---|
| Monday report | | |
| Quote follow-ups | | |
| Meeting notes | | |
| Customer replies | | |
| Job adverts | | |
| Total per week | | |

Minutes per week. Check again after a month.

## Your 30-day plan

9 Start this week

**Week 1**
One repeated job, done with AI

→ **Week 2**
Save the prompts that worked

→ **Week 3**
Set up a Project with your brief

→ **Week 4**
Measure, share, pick the next job

Small and repeated beats big and once.

## Advanced moves

10 Power moves

**Second opinion**
Ask another tool, compare

**Mark against a list**
“Check this against our rules”

**Spot the changes**
“What changed between these?”

**Play the customer**
“Reply as a sceptical buyer”

## When a prompt is not enough

Data in three systems · The same task every day · Mistakes that cost money

That needs a solution built around your business. Tell us what is holding you back, and we’ll tell you whether it is worth fixing.

**Book a call**
aiforcompanies.co.uk/book

Or email hello@aiforcompanies.co.uk